By the late 1960s all the districts of the states were having their own plans with their respective District Planning Boards[89] with the respective District Magistrates being their de-facto chairmen. The district level plans are implemented now via Municipalities or Corporations in the urban areas and the Panchayats via the Blocks in the rural areas.

Fourth Strata: The Block Level Planning

As a part of the district level planning the Block level Planning came up which had the District Planning Boards as their nodal body of planning. Below the Blocks, India developed the planning at the local level, too.

Fifth Strata: The Local Level Planning

By the early 1980s, plans were being implemented at the Local Level via the Blocks and had the District Planning Boards (DPBs) as the nodal agency. Due to socio-economic differentiations among the population, Local Level Planning in India developed with its three variants,[90] namely–

(i) Village Level Planning
(ii) Hill Area Planning
(iii) Tribal Area Planning

Basically, the MLP was started to promote the process of decentralised planning in the country. It was the Indian version of democratic planning which ultimately sought to guarantee the people's participation in the process of planning. But it failed to do so due to many reasons. The reasons have been discussed below:

(i) It could not promote people's participation in the formation of the various plans. The basic idea of the MLP model was that once the local level plans will be handed over to the blocks, the blocks will make their plans and once the blocks hand over their plans to the districts, the district level plans will be formulated. Similarly, the state plans and finally the Five-Year Plan if the Centre will formulate one. By doing so, every idea of planning will have the representation of everybody in the country at the time of plan formation—a special kind of plan empathy would have developed